FaujPrep

PMA LONG COURSE 160 PREPARATION NOTES | NOTE 7 OF 10

ISSB Preparation 2: Psychological Tasks and Self-Consistency

Prepare honestly

Psychological activities may be part of an assessment process, but exact tasks, timing, and interpretation are determined by the official process and can change. Do not rely on leaked prompts, supposed answer keys, or advice to perform a fabricated personality. Consistent, truthful responses are more defensible than trying to guess a desired profile.

Know your own examples

Before attending, reflect on real situations from school, home, sport, work, or community life:

- A responsibility you accepted.
- A disagreement you handled.
- A failure or disappointment and how you responded.
- A time you supported someone else.
- A decision you made with incomplete information.
- A habit or skill you are actively improving.

For each, write what happened, what you did, the result, and what you learned. Keep the details factual; ordinary examples are sufficient.

Practise clear thinking, not canned responses

For a short story or situation prompt, identify the people, immediate problem, practical action, and realistic outcome. Avoid making every story heroic or unrealistically perfect. For sentence-completion or rapid-response exercises, answer naturally and promptly without trying to reverse-engineer a hidden scoring key.

When reflecting on yourself, be specific. "I am responsible" is a claim; "I keep a weekly study schedule and review it every Sunday" is an observable habit. Acknowledge a genuine limitation and a reasonable improvement step rather than claiming to have none.

Worked situation example

Prompt for practice: "Your group is behind schedule and two members disagree about what to do next. What do you do?"

Reasoning steps: identify the immediate goal; get the two options in one sentence each; compare them against time, safety, and available resources; choose a workable next action; communicate who will do it; review whether the plan is working.

Possible response: "I would quickly clarify the deadline and ask each person for the practical reason behind their suggestion. If one option meets the task safely with the resources we have, I would

support it and divide the remaining work. If both have value, I would combine the essential parts and set a short check-in."

Follow-up: "What if the group ignores your suggestion?" A grounded answer: "If the chosen plan is safe and reasonable, I would contribute to it. If I see a specific safety risk, I would state that risk clearly and suggest a safer alternative."

This is a way to practise organized thinking, not a prescribed ISSB response or a claim about a scoring key.

Wellbeing before the assessment

Sleep adequately, eat normally, and avoid experimenting with stimulants or supplements. If anxiety is affecting sleep or daily life, speak with a trusted adult or qualified health professional. Short breathing practice can help settle nerves, but it does not replace preparation or professional care.

Avoid counterproductive coaching

- Memorising copied stories or personality descriptions.
- Trying to look flawless or emotionless.
- Rehearsing a single "correct" answer for every scenario.
- Comparing your answers with rumours about other candidates.
- Staying up late to practise hundreds of prompts.

A reflection exercise

Write a truthful one-page account of your responsibilities, values, strengths, and development areas. Ask a family member or teacher whether it sounds like you. Use the feedback to become clearer, not to replace your own judgement with someone else's script.

Reminder

No self-presentation technique can guarantee selection. The assessment belongs to the official board; answer honestly and follow its instructions.

Research basis

The ISSB candidate guidelines (https://issb.gov.pk/guidelines) advise candidates to avoid private ISSB coaching that can make thinking rigid, and recommend the Board's own guidance material. They also caution against false projection. This note does not claim to reproduce official psychological prompts or scoring.